

themselves. There is a lightbulb moment for so many people when they realize that their money issues are rooted in other things, but it can be very frustrating to try to have a conversation with people who aren't quite there yet – or people who stubbornly refuse to accept it.

We're taught that it's not polite

The prickly fence around discussing money in a real, honest way is often put down to 'Britishness', but I'm not sure that that's always the case. It's true that, perhaps, in other cultures money is spoken about more openly, but I think there's still a lot that goes unsaid. With any discussion about money comes the inevitable associations of work, value and power, and that's not something anyone I've ever encountered seems to be comfortable with discussing at the pub. If we are squeamish about discussing money, it is for good reason. It's very difficult to talk about it in any meaningful way without venturing into uncharted territory, and peeling away the layers and complexities that underpin both our personal relationship with it and its role in our society can make things very uncomfortable very quickly.

As a society, we are quickly taught that broaching conversations that will inevitably lead to discomfort is not polite, and so we are conditioned towards small talk – which is fine in the office, or at a PTA barbecue, but these are things that we should be able to discuss with those close to us, at the very least. Yet